



Big in every way

The Very Large Array (VLA) in New Mexico has 27 dishes, each 5 m (82 ft) in diameter. Used individually or together to sweep the sky for signals, they rest on tracks and can be spread over 36 km (22 miles)!



People need to get inside the dishes to carry out repairs and maintenance.

did you know?

Diesel cars are used near radio observatories, as the spark plugs in petrol-powered cars can create radio waves that interfere with the ones from space.

Astronomers didn't discover radio waves from space until 1932.